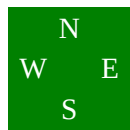


Board 2
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ J 10 9 4
 ♥ J 9 3
 ♦ 10 9 3
 ♣ 8 5 2

♠ K 7 3
 ♥ K 8 4
 ♦ A K J
 ♣ K J 10 6



♠ A Q 8
 ♥ A 7 6 2
 ♦ 8 5 4
 ♣ A Q 9

♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ Q 10 5
 ♦ Q 7 6 2
 ♣ 7 4 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	6NT		1NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			

Partner has a balanced hand with 15-17 points. You have a balanced hand with 18 points. Together that makes two balanced hands with 33-35 points.

So you bid 6NT.

North would play 6NT.

Click

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠ J.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

It's nice to make Plans for slams because there are so few losers to worry about.

This one is definitely straightforward. You need to get one more winner. You can hope for a 3-3 ♥ split which would mean your fourth ♥ would become a winner, or you can hope that West has the ♦ Q in which case a simple finesse will give you the winner. But instead of making it an either/or situation you can combine your chances.

Win the first trick in either hand and duck a ♥. Win the return and play your 4 ♣ winners (discarding a ♦ from your hand) followed by your other 2 ♠ winners. Then play ♦ A, ♥ K and ♥ A. You will be in your hand with two cards - the ♥ 7 and the ♦ 8. If the ♥ 7 is good, cash it and win the last trick with dummy's ♦ K. If the ♥ 7 is not a winner then finesse the ♦ J.

Always be on the lookout for situations where there are two possible routes to success.

Here the ♦ finesse was one possibility, but by ducking a ♥ you could test the ♥ suit and still keep the ♦ finesse in reserve.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3 2

♥ A 8

♦ K Q J 3

♣ 8 7 4 3

♠ Q J 5

♥ Q 9 6 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ Q J 6



♠ 8

♥ K 7 5 4

♦ 10 8 6

♣ K 10 9 5 2

♠ A K 10 9 6 4

♥ J 10 3

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

2♠

All Pass

4♠

4♠ by South

You open 1♠ and partner responds 2♥.

With only 14 points and a 6-card suit you rebid a minimum 2♠. Partner raises to 3♠.

Your bids show 13-15 points. Partner has decided to invite you to bid game with a maximum. Since you have 14 points it's not really clear whether you should accept the invitation. You decide to add a little for your singleton Ace and bid 4♠.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦K.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

The two fast losers in ♥s can't be helped, but maybe you can get rid of one of the ♦ losers.

Win the ♦A and play the ♣6 to your ♣A. Play ♠A, then a small ♠ to dummy's ♠J. Lead the ♣Q. If East covers, ruff and re-enter dummy with a trump so you can discard a ♦ loser on the ♣J. If East doesn't cover the ♣Q when you lead it, discard a ♦ immediately. As long as East holds the ♣K you can make the contract. This is called a Ruffing Finesse.

In some hands there is more than one way to make the contract.

But in this deal the ruffing finesse is the only Plan that works.